

Breaking Language Barriers

Background

Online and hybrid learning depend heavily on real-time communication through audio calls, video calls, chat, and collaborative group activities. Learners and facilitators may have different levels of language proficiency. These differences can lead to misunderstandings, reduced participation, slower discussions, and difficulty completing group work. Learners may hesitate to speak, miss important instructions, or struggle to express their ideas. Facilitators may also find it difficult to confirm whether participants have understood the discussion.

Challenge Statement

Design and build a working prototype that helps learners and facilitators communicate more clearly across language differences during real-time online or hybrid learning sessions. The solution should improve communication during live interactions, including facilitator-led discussions, question-and-answer sessions, peer conversations, and group work.

Your Solution

Your prototype should improve at least one real-time interaction:

- Facilitator-to-learner communication
- Learner questions and responses
- Peer discussions

Possible features include live captions, speech translation, multilingual chat, translated questions, or tools that identify misunderstandings.

Minimum Requirements

The prototype must:

- Support both learners and facilitators
- Support at least two languages
- Be demonstrated in a realistic learning scenario with real-time communication.
- Consider response speed, accuracy, accessibility, and privacy

Deliverables

Each team must present:

- A working prototype
- A short live demonstration

Judging Criteria

- **Impact:** Improves understanding, participation, or collaboration.
- **Prototype Quality:** Works reliably and is easy to use.
- **Innovation and Feasibility:** Original, practical, and suitable for real learning environments.

Suggested Demo

Show a facilitator speaking in one language while a learner receives captions or translation, responds in another language, and participates in the discussion.